

Best Ball Butts 2026: Week 5 outlook

As of 2026-10-07. Weeks 1–4 are final and locked in; Week 5 starts Thursday. The numbers are the average of 12 season simulations (6 projection sources × 2 noise models, 8,000 seasons each) on the real schedule, best-ball scoring and Sleeper's 6-team bracket.

TL;DR

- **Noelle and Emma are now nearly level at the top: Noelle 26.1% (was 30.2%), Emma 25.2% (was 20.5%).** Emma beat Noelle 207.8–183.4 in Week 4 and leads the league in points (827.1). Emma is 1st in 8 of 12 runs, Noelle in 3.
- **Ben is a clear 3rd at 17.5%** (was 14.2%) after a league-high 208.9 against Raghav. Five teams are 3-1.
- **Raghav drops to 4th at 9.3%** (was 14.2%) with Mayfield and Etienne out and Chase in the concussion protocol. Conrad 9.0%, Henry 6.4%, Lauren 6.2%, Avery 0.4% (last in all 12 runs).

Standings odds

#	Manager	Rec	PF	Title %	Range	Playoff %	Bye %	Prior edition (Sep 30)	Δ
1	Noelle	3-1	809.8	26.1	19–31	98.6	61.5	30.2	−4.1
2	Emma	3-1	827.1	25.2	13–35	97.8	54.9	20.5	+4.7
3	Ben	3-1	761.1	17.5	12–21	96.7	42.5	14.2	+3.3
4	Raghav	3-1	686.2	9.3	4–19	87.0	20.9	14.2	−4.9
5	Conrad	1-3	680.4	9.0	5–17	72.9	6.4	5.7	+3.3
6	Henry	0-4	703.9	6.4	5–9	59.2	2.7	7.3	−0.9
7	Lauren	3-1	718.6	6.2	2–12	78.8	10.8	6.7	−0.5
8	Avery	0-4	628.2	0.4	0–1	9.0	0.1	1.2	−0.8

What changed since last week

- **Week 4:** Emma beat Noelle (207.8–183.4), Ben beat Raghav (208.9–155.3), Conrad beat Henry (205.5–201.8) and Lauren beat Avery (168.2–138.6). Tetairoa McMillan (Conrad) had the week's top score at 45.2, ahead of CeeDee Lamb (Ben) at 41.3 and Kyren Williams (Ben) at 36.7.
- **Raghav's injuries deepened:** Etienne went on IR (earliest return Week 9), Mayfield is out for Week 5, Chase is in the concussion protocol and McConkey re-aggravated his foot. Raghav dropped Achane (ACL) and added Ty Johnson for 20 FAAB.
- **Emma's QB is hurt:** Lamar Jackson's ankle sprain makes him unlikely for Week 5, and McLaurin (hamstring) is a game-time call. Javonte Williams (31.3) and Kenneth Walker (30.9) carried Week 4.
- **Other injuries:** Barkley and DeVonta Smith (both Avery) are out for Week 5 and Bigsby went on IR. Jadarian Price (Noelle) is on IR through Week 7, and A.J. Brown (Henry) is out until about Week 7. Nacua (Conrad) is back and had 27.7. Rice (Lauren) has a hamstring tweak, with KC on bye in Week 5.
- **Moves:** Henry claimed Kalif Raymond for 100 FAAB, dropping Jayden Reed. Conrad dropped Justin Herbert for the Bears D/ST and Jonah Coleman for kicker Spencer Shrader.

Team by team

- **Noelle (26.1%):** 3-1 and 2nd in points, but 1st in only 3 of 12 runs (2nd in the other 9) after the Week 4 loss. Daniels is expected back for Week 5; Price, Pierce and Charbonnet are still out.
- **Emma (25.2%):** 3-1 with the league's most points and 1st in 8 of 12 runs. Lamar's ankle is the main risk; only the market and production sources (13–14%) rate her well below the leaders.
- **Ben (17.5%):** 3-1 and 3rd in 8 of 12 runs (2nd in two), with a league-high 208.9 in Week 4. Stevenson out-snapped Henderson 66% to 37%, and White is a Week 5 question.
- **Raghav (9.3%):** 3-1 but 6th in points. With the record removed he'd rank 6th at 7.8%. Only the market source still rates him near the top (about 19%).
- **Conrad (9.0%):** 1-3, but up 3.3 points after a 205.5-point win, and 4th with the record removed (12.4%). Nacua is healthy again; Kamara and Love have minor Week 5 knocks.

- **Henry (6.4%):** 0-4 despite 703.9 points; his four losses include one by 3.7. He's 5th with the record removed (11.2%), but Hall, Goedert and Brown are all out or doubtful for Week 5.
- **Lauren (6.2%):** 3-1 but 7th with the record removed (4.6%). Monangai scored 28.0, while Jacobs, Sampson, Coker and Rice are all unavailable or limited.
- **Avery (0.4%):** 0-4 and last in all 12 runs, with Barkley, Smith and Bigsby out and Jefferson a game-time call.

Data checks

- **D/ST scoring:** all 49 defense scores in Weeks 1–4 match a recount from Sleeper's raw stats (0 mismatches, 0 zero scores).
- **Data source:** rosters, byes and projections came through Raghav's gateway MCP (`sleeper-draft__export_league_snapshot`, sha256-verified). The direct-API fallback was not used.
- **Caveats:** rosters are frozen from here (no waivers or trades). Injury news was checked before Wednesday's first practice, so Week 5 game-time decisions are scored as partial chances: Chase, McLaurin, Hall and Douglas 0.5; Jefferson, McConkey, Moore 0.6; White 0.65; Love and Higgins 0.75. Timelines for Jacobs, Sampson, Pierce and Rice are low-confidence estimates.